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THE TOILET PAPER RATION



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Amy: *(to audience)* If it hadn't happened in my own school. I would have never of believed it. It was like a week long *Saturday Night Live* skit. I kept waiting for Miss. Flazz, my home room teacher, to stand at any moment and scream, "LIVE FROM NEW YORK!". But, she didn't. I first caught wind of the entire thing through my girlfriend Toni.

Toni: Anyway, did you hear what the two grubby freshman boys did?

Amy: What boys?

Toni: You know the real grubby ones? The two that never shower after gym class?

Amy: Oh.

Toni: Anyway did you hear?

Amy: No, spill it.

Toni: Those two got caught throwing rolls of toilet paper all over the gym on Saturday. They broke into the school through that one door around back that never latches. Anyway, they dug around in the janitor's closet and must of stole like 4,000 rolls or something. Anyway, they needed a rolley cart to get it all to the gym. Anyway, they were shooting hoops with the stuff for like hours. Someone said it was like two feet deep all over.

Amy: No way, that is so stupid. Who caught them?

Toni: That was weird too. You know those two really hot dudes?

Amy: No Toni, what dudes?

Toni: The *really* hot ones, you know.

Amy: Oh, those two.

Toni: Anyway, they broke into the school through that door around back that doesn't latch so they could play some basketball, and they saw the two grubbers doing it.

Amy: Did they get into trouble?

Toni: No way! The one hot one's dad is on the school board. They were like *citizens of the year* for turning in the toilet paper pukes.

Amy: *(to audience)* So, that's how it started. As the week went on I noticed that each of the stalls were running low on paper. By Friday only one stall, the one with no door, still had paper. Monday morning is when the order came down from above in the way of an announcement.

Announcement: *This is Mr. Bunch, your principal. As many of you have noticed there is no toilet paper in the restrooms. I want you to know this is not an error but on purpose. Due to a recent incident we are no longer able to trust the student body. So, from now on, if you wish to use the restroom, you must get paper from your teacher. Each home room teacher has been issued an allotted amount of which they will be held accountable. Have a nice day.*

Amy: *(to audience)* That was it. We all stared toward the front of the room. Miss Flazz was nodding her head up and down. I need to explain that she was a first year teacher and thought that every order from the administration was direct from God. Miss Flazz pulled two pristine white rolls from the lower drawer of her desk. She placed them in front of us.

Miss Flazz: You heard the man. From now on if you want to use the restroom you must see me first. I need to keep track. I have a ledger where I can put your name and, well, your business so I can turn it in to Mr. Bunch. For example, let's say Amy....

Amy: *(to audience)* OH MY GOD! She said my name. Please, why me?

Miss Flazz: Let's say Amy needs to do a number two.

Amy: *(to audience)* OH MY GOD! Tell me this really isn't happening.

Miss Flazz: Number two. Amy would place her name on the ledger and a brief description. I would then issue the appropriate amount as to complete the job. And then I would log the number of squares issued. Any questions?

Amy: *(to audience)* I felt like raising my hand. "Yes, Miss Flazz. Can I die now?!" However, Jennifer Tanker really did ask a question. Jennifer is one of those girls that has always been 32. She had boobs in the 3rd grade. She was rough. Always in black jeans and Harley t-shirts.

Jennifer: Miss Fazz, what if it is that time of the month?
Amy: *(to audience)* OH MY GOD! I can't believe she asked that with dudes in the room. I

gave a quick look around and even the boys had crimson faces and were giggling weakly. Jennifer had found a loophole. Mentally, I made a note. I knew for my male teachers all I had to do was drop the ol' "It's that time of the month" bomb and they would hand over the whole roll, maybe both. But Miss Flazz was unfortunately not male.

Jennifer: How much do we get for that?

Miss Flazz: Well, Miss Tanker it depends on the flow.

Amy: *(to audience)* OH MY GOD! I wanted to disappear. I normally would have asked to go to the restroom but not now. Not under the new imposed Marshal Law. Even Jennifer shut up after that comment.

Miss Flazz: Any other questions?

Amy: *(to audience)* Yeah right. I'm not sure if anyone will be able to ask a question for the rest of the year without the word, "FLOW" flooding their brain.

Miss Flazz: Very well. Take out your books and turn to chapter 5. This unit will deal with the rise and fall of the former Soviet Union.

Amy: No one, I mean no one went to the bathroom for the first two days. Some learned to hold it. Some kids brought their own paper from home and used the bathroom between classes but this came to an abrupt end when disaster struck on Thursday. I again learned through the informed source, Toni.

Toni: So, anyway one of the stools in the boy's bathroom at the other end of school clogged and overflowed out into the hall during 3rd hour. Mr. Bunch checked all the ledgers and no one could explain where the paper came from.

Amy: So, what does that mean?*(to audience)* I didn't have to wait long for my answer as my thoughts were interrupted by the intercom.

Announcement: *This is Mr. Bunch, your principal. I have learned that many of you are trying to make fools of this administration by bringing your own paper from home. That will stop as of today. Any student caught with unissued paper will receive a two hour detention and lose bathroom privileges for the remainder of the year. Have a nice day.*

Amy: *(to audience)* Toilet paper was now considered contraband. The permission barrier was finally broken on Thursday. Stan Tolkskien squirmed for most of 1st hour before coming to grips with the fact that it was either suffer the humiliation of going in his pants or submit to the humiliation of the ledger. Stan rose from his desk and approached Miss Flazz.

Stan: *(whispering)* Miss Flazz? I need to use the restroom.

Miss Flazz: Very well Mr. Tolkskien. What will we be doing today?
Stan: *(whispering)* Miss Flazz, I'm a guy.

Miss Flazz: *(laughing)* That's right, I forgot. Here put your name on the ledger. In the space marked **description** just put a number two. How much are we looking at here? Five, six squares.

Stan: *(whispering)* Miss Flazz, I don't think that will be enough.

Miss Flazz: What number are you thinking?

Stan: *(whispering)* I'm not sure. I've never really counted. Could I have fifteen or so just to be safe?

Miss Flazz: Fifteen? I think that is way too much. How about ten?

Stan: *(whispering)* How about thirteen?

Miss Flazz: Eleven!

Stan: Twelve!

Miss Flazz: Twelve it is.

Amy: *(to audience)* I couldn't believe it. They were haggling over the right amount. I thought I was listening to a South American street vender working a tourist. Miss Flazz pulled a roll from her desk and carefully counted twelve individual squares and handed them over to Stan who quickly disappeared from the room. Everyone was staring in awe as if he were some super-human. I felt like standing and clapping. However, upon his return, tragedy struck.

Miss Flazz: Mr. Tolkskien, What is that on your shoe?

Amy: *(to audience)* We all looked down at his shoe. There, in plain sight was his crime. Three white, unused squares were stuck to his heal.

Miss Flazz: TWELVE! TWELVE! I think I have a little liar on my hands.

Amy: *(to audience)* Why didn't he just flush it; get rid of the evidence?

Miss Flazz: Mr. Liar, Mr. Paper Thief, why don't you just march yourself right down to Mr. Bunch's office and explain yourself to him.

Stan: But Miss Flazz.... I....I ... wasn't sure.... I....

Miss Flazz: MARCH! Mr. Waster, Mr. Consumption, Mr. Squanderer. MARCH!

Amy: *(to audience)* She was the *Roget's Thesaurus* of verbal abuse. In tears, Stan turned and left. He was not seen the rest of the day.

Miss Flazz: Let that be a lesson to all of you. From now on I will expect an accurate account of your plans and then **I** will determine the needed amount. Do you ALL understand?

Amy: *(to audience)* At that moment Cole Lampe stood. I should note, Cole is a *very* large boy. I once overheard him tell another student in the hall that he was bumping 400 pounds. I should also note, and there is no real nice way to say this, Cole stank. I'm not talking a mild aroma but more of an odor that grabs you by both shoulders and shakes you while screaming, "Run, by God, or you will DIE!"Cole appeared never to bathe and was continually leaking gas from both ends. As he approached Miss Flazz' desk, I saw her face change. She quickly scrambled in the desk and handed both rolls to Cole without a word. Cole smiled and left the room. We all sighed in relief. To cause a delay once Cole' intestines were in motion could have meant an end to us all.

On Friday it happened. I had to go. It was a stupid mistake, I should have known better. I downed a *Diet Pepsi* between classes. I was only ten minutes into class when it hit. I ignored it at first, trying desperately to concentrate on the Soviet Union. Trotsky, Lenin, Marx, Bloody Sunday, waterfalls, trickling streams, I was losing the battle. Finally, I was faced with the same decision that poor Stan had to make. But maybe, just maybe, Cole had broken the barrier? I rose and approached the front.

Amy: *(whispering)* Miss Flazz? Miss Flazz? I need to use the restroom.

Miss Flazz: Excellent!

Amy: *(to audience)* She seemed to be excited as she dug into her drawer and pulled out both the ledger and a roll of paper.

Miss Flazz: Very well, let' get down to the details. Just what is the nature of this trip?

Amy: *(whispering)* I have to go pee.

Miss Flazz: And?????

Amy: *(whispering)* And????What????

Miss Flazz: That just isn't enough information for me to make an accurate assessment concerning the proper number of squares to be issued. I need something more. Anything you can provide would be helpful.

Amy: *(whispering to audience)* She's lost it. Some bizarre transformation. Why am I whispering? *(out loud)* Some bizarre transformation had taken place. She had become this power hungry monster. *Her* control over *our* bodily functions had turned her into a butt-paper dictator.

Amy: *(whispering, frantic)* I just don't know what you are looking for? I just have to go. I drank some soda and now I have to go.

Miss Flazz: How many ounces?

Amy: *(no longer whispering)* What does that have to do with anything! Miss Flazz, I HAVE TO GO NOW! *(to audience)* I had snapped. I could hear the excited mumbling of a disturbed mob behind me. Supportive comments like, "You tell her Amy!" and "Yeah, get her girl!" With my crowd support growing, I seized the opportunity for the overthrow. I grabbed the whole roll and ran out the door screaming in my best William Wallace voice, "FREEDOM! FREEDOM!"

Upon my return I was sent to the office, a martyr for the cause. Boldly, proudly I strolled from the room, a hero.

Amy: On Monday, the iron fist of oppression came to abrupt end. Toni was again my fountain of gossip.

Toni: Anyway, did you hear what happened over the weekend?

Amy: No, spill it.

Toni: OK, anyway like all the parents must have called the school board cause that one hot dude told me his dad got like a gajillion calls. I guess Mr. Bunch is in a crap load of trouble.

Amy: Is he going to be fired?

Toni: Like I know. Anyway, the bathrooms all have paper. I already checked them all.

Amy: *(to audience)* And just like that is was over. My thoughts were once again interrupted by the all too familiar voice from the loud speaker.

Announcement: *This is Mr. Bunch, your principal. It seems as though I need to apologize to all of the student body for last week's misunderstanding. The toilet paper ration is no longer in effect. Those of you who were caught with the contraband, I mean paper, will not be made to serve your detentions. Have a nice day.*

Amy: *(to audience)* There you have it. Like I said if it hadn't happened at my own school I would have thought is was an urban legend. But as I lived through it, I swear that my account is true. Forever it will be remembered as simply, ***The toilet paper ration***.

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